



Crop: Hot pepper (*Capsicum frutescens*) – EPPO Code: CPSFR

Pathogen: *Xanthomonas campestris* pv. *Vesicatoria* ((Bacterial leaf spot of pepper) - EPPO Code: XANTAV

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Suggested control Measures:

Causal agent: *Xanthomonas campestris* pv. *vesicatoria*

Symptoms:

Water-soaked lesions on the leaves that enlarge into spots and stem canker. The spots dry up eventually, and damaged tissues can fall off. Spots can also appear on the fruits, reducing their marketability.

Management practices:

- Use certified pathogen-free seeds and seedling
- Remove visible disease transplants, infected crop residues, and weeds/volunteer plants
- Avoid splash/overhead irrigation. Use furrow or drip irrigation instead.
- Rotation with non-Solanaceae crops
- Use resistant varieties (if available).

Seed treatments:

- Wash seeds with Clorox solution (two parts Clorox and eight parts water) for 40 minutes
- Soak seeds in hot water for 30 minutes
- Spray copper-based pesticides like mancozeb
- Biological control with beneficial organisms

Integrating more than one of the above-mentioned options in a compatible manner should provide effective, economical, and sustainable leaf spot management.

